

CHAIYA

A brand-reinvention case for RE:BRAND

Case note: CHAIYA is a fictional chai-and-snacks chain. All figures, surveys, financials and market data are fictional and created for this competition.

Use the evidence to identify the most important challenge facing CHAIYA and build a defensible rebranding and growth response. The central problem is not stated directly.

1. COMPANY STORY

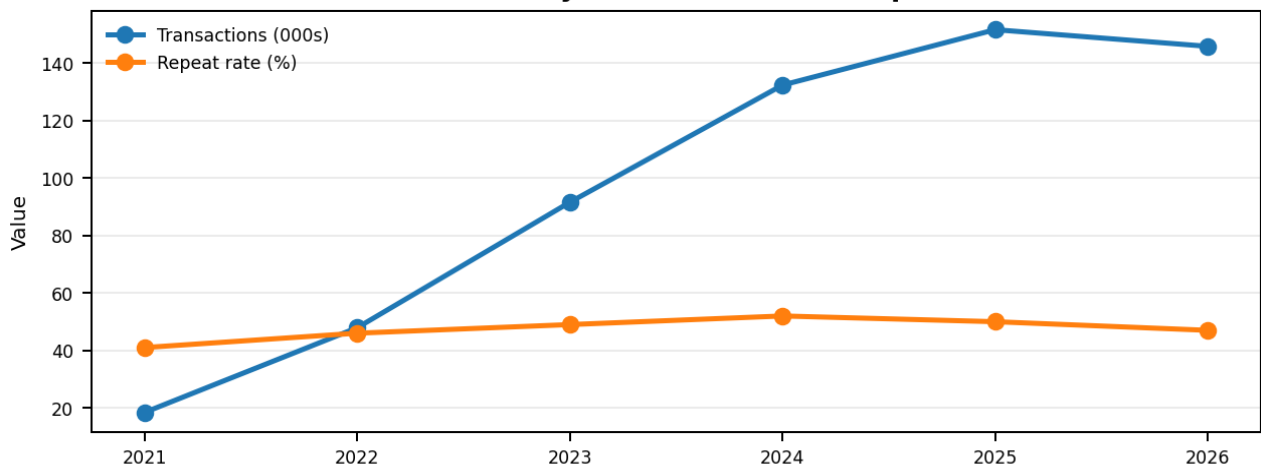
CHAIYA began in 2021 in the fictional city of Navapur with a promise of dependable chai, quick snacks and a familiar local atmosphere. It expanded from neighbourhood stores into three cities. Management is now preparing a three-year growth plan and wants to reconsider the brand from the ground up.

2. BUSINESS SNAPSHOT

Year	Cities	Outlets	Monthly transactions	Avg. bill (INR)	Repeat rate
2021	1	2	18,400	92	41%
2022	1	5	47,900	101	46%
2023	2	9	91,600	112	49%
2024	2	13	132,400	126	52%
2025	3	17	151,700	141	50%
2026*	3	18	145,900	148	47%

*2026 figures are Jan-Aug averages or annualised where stated.

CHAIYA: Monthly transactions and repeat rate

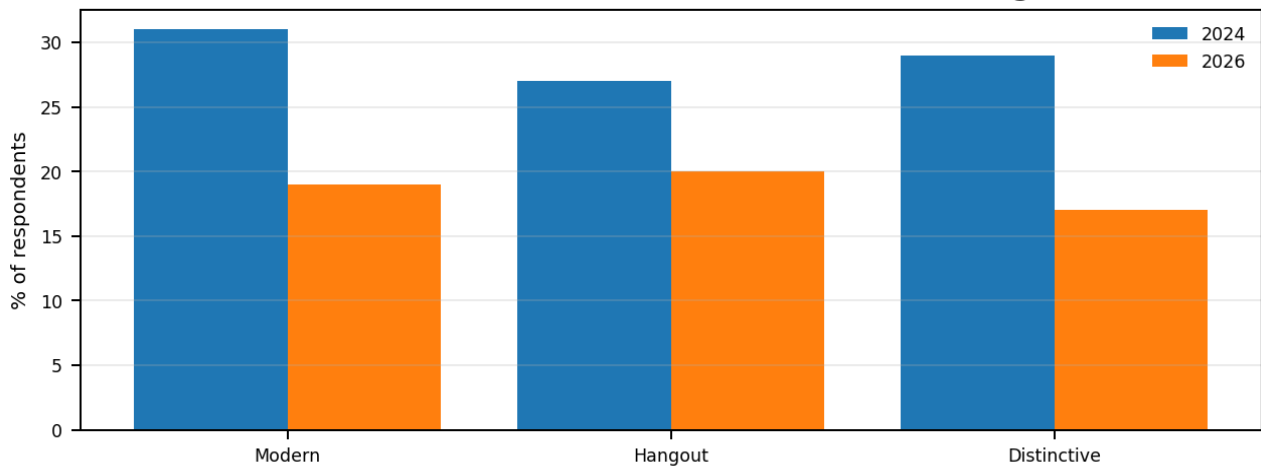


The chart shows scale growth alongside a recent softening in repeat behaviour.

3. CUSTOMER / PRODUCT EVIDENCE

Metric	2021	2023	2025	2026*
Revenue (INR cr)	1.8	7.1	16.8	15.9
Customers aged 18–24	28%	31%	29%	23%
Customers aged 25–34	24%	26%	31%	35%
Delivery share	7%	12%	19%	23%
Avg. visits / month	2.6	3.1	3.0	2.7
Modern brand association	—	—	31% (2024)	19%
Distinctive / memorable	—	—	29% (2024)	17%

Brand associations: selected 2024 → 2026 changes



The comparison is based on a 2026 survey of 1,200 customers across three cities.

4. CUSTOMER VOICE

- “The chai is fine, but I could get something similar anywhere.”
- “I go there when it is nearby—not really because it is CHAIYA.”
- “The newer cafés feel more interesting for meeting people.”
- “The prices are okay, but the brand doesn't give me a reason to choose it.”

5. COMPETITIVE CONTEXT & CONSTRAINTS

Competitor type	Typical positioning	Observed strength
Local chai stalls	Low-cost / familiar	Very low prices; speed
Modern café chains	Lifestyle / social	Ambience; visual identity; shareable products
Food delivery brands	Convenience / variety	Discovery; discounts; home delivery

- The brand must remain recognisably Indian and chai-led.
- The current menu and supply chain cannot be rebuilt from scratch.
- Large-scale advertising budgets, celebrity endorsements and unlimited technology are not available.
- Changes may be made to positioning, communication, store experience, packaging, loyalty, partnerships and marketing.

6. THE BRIEF

What should CHAIYA become in the minds of customers over the next three years, and how should the brand express that change?

7. PARTICIPANT NOTES

- Separate symptoms from root causes.
- Use numbers and customer quotes as evidence.
- Label assumptions clearly.
- More than one defensible solution is possible.